it, being among the 42 MLAs who resigned in 2016 to protest the Supreme Court ruling in favour of Haryana in the Sutlej-Yamuna Link case and being the first to rebel against Amarinder Singh in 2021-22. A four-time MLA, former deputy CM, and now Congress general secretary overseeing party affairs in neighbouring Rajasthan, Sukhjinder marks his parliamentary debut from Gurdaspur by defeating the BJP's Dinesh Singh Babbu.



▲ G.M. HARISH BALAYOGI, *33*

| TDP | *Amalapuram (SC), Andhra Pradesh*

Son of G.M.C. Balayogi, the first Dalit Speaker of the Lok Sabha and its youngest, whose life was tragically cut short when he died in a chopper crash in 2002, Harish wants to fulfil his father's dream—of getting the rail ministry to commission the 57-km Kotipalli-Narasapuram railway. His mother had occupied the LS seat in the bypoll after his father's death. Harish too had contested for it in 2019, but lost. Now that this MBA grad has won, defeating the YSRCP's R. Varaprasad Rao by 300,000 votes, he also intends to push for access to safe drinking water that eludes a fourth of his constituents.

▶ ANUP DHOTRE, *40*

| BJP | *Akola, Maharashtra*

Despite crafting an Akola pattern of social engineering—whereby members of different marginalised groups were given representation on rotation—Prakash Ambedkar, grandson of Babasaheb Ambedkar, could reap political dividend only on two occasions, when he won the Congress seat in 1998, and in alliance with the Congress in 1999. Bringing that run to a halt was none other than Anup's father, Sanjay, who first wrested the seat in 2004 and maintained a stranglehold on it until ill health forced him to nominate son Anup this time. Anup did not disappoint, yet again defeating Ambedkar of the Vanchit Bahujan Aghadi, and Dr Abhay Patil of the Congress to preserve the family legacy.





▲ ARUN BHARTI, *48*

| LJP(RV) | *Jamui (SC), Bihar*

Married to Chirag Paswan's sister Nisha, '*jawain babu*' Bharti was parachuted into Jamui after Chirag, who represented the SC-reserved constituency in 2014 and 2019, shifted to Hajipur. Arun, who has a degree in finance from the University of Strathclyde, Glasgow, was by Chirag's side in the battle to claim Paswan Sr's legacy after his death in 2020 against uncle Pashupati Paras. When Jamui fell vacant, he became a natural choice.

▶ DR HEMANT SAVARA, *47*

| BJP | *Palghar (ST), Maharashtra*



Son of Vishnu Savara, a five-term MLA and former tribal development minister, Hemant had contested the 2019 state election from Vikramgad when his father took ill, but lost. He, however, kept up his public outreach and was nominated the BJP candidate for the tribal reserved seat. Hemant managed to win despite Bharti Kamdi of the Shiv Sena (UBT) securing the support of the CPI(M), which has a base in areas like Dahanu and Talasari in the district.



◀ ANAND KUMAR GOND, *49*

| BJP | *Bahraich (SC), UP*

Anand takes over from father Akshayabar Lal Gond, the Bahraich MP before him. A PhD and an MBA and owner of several businesses, Anand did not disappoint and helped the BJP attain a hat trick of wins from this Lok Sabha seat.